

GENDER



BENDERS

Nachiket Mhatre vs Urmila Rane

Enabling A Tone Alert For Num Lock, Caps Lock and Scroll Lock



5 sec

A computer engineering student, Nachiket was excited about Gender Benders. On being told his task, he just said, "That's in the Accessibility Options, right?" We were kind of taken aback. He went the window to do the changes by typing the following command on the Run window - access.cpl. And next he enabled the 'Use ToggleKeys' option. There, the job was done in the blink of an eye. And he didn't even have to think much! Very impressive Indeed!

3 min
22 sec

Urmila was at ease, though she wasn't sure about the solution. She went to the right place anyway—the Control Panel. She considered 'Sounds' and 'Audio Devices' first. But nothing there! Next, she looked at other options including 'System', 'Keyboard' and 'Accessibility'. She felt she couldn't nail it here, so she exited that window just as fast as she had entered it. When she did realise that the answer actually lay within 'Accessibility options', she went back there and zeroed in. Good line of thought, girl, but be quicker next time!

The T1s will be the brain behind the Sun Fire servers that the company plans to launch later this month. Sun claims that this chip—with eight processing cores—is a five-year leap over its existing competitors, namely IBM's Power chip and Intel's Xeon microprocessors. Sun hopes this energy-efficient chip will drive customers to buy Sparc-Solaris servers.

With an energy crisis looming on the horizon, albeit distant, any move towards energy conservation will be met with applause. Sun is hoping that this applause turn into sales figures and lift sagging profits. At Sun's Summit on 21st Century Eco-Responsibility on 14 November, CEO Scott McNealy said Sun would make money in a "socially

and eco-responsible way."

According to Sun, "The impact on our environment is real: if half the entry servers sold in the last three years were replaced with the UltraSPARC T1 processors, over 11 million tons of CO₂ emissions, or the equivalent of that emitted by about a million SUVs, would be eliminated each year."

PHILIPS EYES INDIA

Mobiles for Less

Philips, the electronics giant, sees India as a testing ground for its products. Speaking to reporters in Bangalore, CEO Gerard Kleisterlee said India's large population makes it the best testing ground for solutions that address the unmet needs of the four billion people at the bottom of the global economic pyramid.

In a bid to address a number of technological concerns, Philips plans to increase both the staff and manufacturing and research capabilities in the country. Among many of the initiatives undertaken by Philips are the DISHA (Distance Healthcare Advancement) programme, a telemedicine initiative that it began in July 2005 to provide healthcare to rural communities, and the endeavour to manufacture a sub-Rs 1,000 mobile phone. To achieve this, Philips is currently developing the Nexperia cellular system, which will develop and mass-produce low-cost chipsets for

mobile phones. These chips are slated to cost not more than Rs 250 a piece. This is a major cost reduction from the current levels of over Rs 1,000 per chipset.

By undertaking moves that will help the general masses, especially those who haven't yet benefited from the boom in the technological advances and innovations, of the past few years, Philips is attempting to become a truly global corporation that can meet consumer demands anywhere in the world.

SKY-HIGH WI-FI

Balloon Beams Broadband!

A balloon floating 24,000 metres above the earth has been used to test, for the first time, a lightning-fast data downlink (read broadband!) from the stratosphere, one of the topmost layers of the atmosphere. The helium balloon was tested on 31 August for several hours. Analysis now shows the test was a success, and that it sent data to the ground at 1.25 Gbps—which is a thousand times the speed of a typical home broadband connection.

The test craft was developed by the Capanina Consortium—14 European academic and industry partners funded mainly by the EU. They hope such craft may be able to provide low-cost internet access in the developing world, or perhaps communications in

Flock

Blogs of a feather Flock together—that seems to be the idea behind a new browser that will soon hit the average Internet user. Flock, the browser, looks very similar to Firefox, which isn't surprising considering both share the Mozilla core. The best part about this browser is that it lets you add blog posts right through the user interface: it has a blog tab, and features widely-compliant WYSIWYG, drag-

and-drop blogging tools.

Advertised as a 'social browser,' Flock incorporates very well with 'social' things on the Web such as Flickr and del.icio.us. With the mission of integrating all our Web activities—blogging, photo sharing, wikis, maps, podcasting and video blogging included—into a one-system-one-UI product, Flock sure is the buzz in the tech world!

Buzzword
of the MONTH